multiple tributaries merge into a giant river. The Yatra thus becomes a useful instrument to study how group solidarities are forged and mass consciousness can be shaped.

Section three of the volume outlines the raison d'être of some of India's foremost stakeholders for joining the Yatra. Most progressives originally came to express their frustrations (that remained in public conscience but were being suppressed from being cogently channelized). But the Yatra compelled most progressives who joined to recalibrate their views on Rahul Gandhi and the Congress party. For example, Professor Ajay Gudavarthy argues that the Yatra disrupted the inertia that the Congress Party had settled into, and forced it to unlearn and relearn ideological politics. Interestingly, this sentiment is mirrored by senior Congress leader Salman Khurshid, who asserts that the Yatra forced the party to confront its internal weaknesses and nurture an army of political entrepreneurs. Likewise, finding themselves moved by the commitment and idealism of the Congresspersons they encountered, both Sandesh Bhandare and Darshan Mondkar argued that the Yatra profoundly changed their views on the Congress party in general and Rahul Gandhi in particular.

This is partly because the Yatra consciously confronted the manufactured amnesia of the injustices of the past decade and the oppressive atmosphere of hate, as Sridhar suggests in his essay. It also provided, as A.S. Dulat asserts, a symbolic balm to the most vulnerable and disenfranchised, like the people of Jammu and Kashmir. The Yatra also connected millions of progressives with each other, who so far felt they had been entirely alone in their fight for a liberal, secular and democratic society. As Professor Mukulika Banerjee suggests, the Yatra and this mini India on the move collectively posed an alternative imagining of India.

As numerous articles in this volume attest, many people who witnessed the Yatra (either purposely or through happenstance) perceived it to be a spiritual journey and proactively told us that we were performing a great tapasya (sacrifice) for the nation. The fact that like Adi Shankaracharya, Gautama Buddha and Mahatma Gandhi once did, we were walking to propagate what we believed in conferred on the BJY a special status in